MIGRATION

Migration usually is referred to as movement of people either individually or in a group. Movement involves a temporal (time related) and spatial (space related) movements. Movements of Nomads, gatherers, tourists, trips related to work, long-term or short-term labour migration and permanent migration are certain kinds of migrations which can be cited. These involve movements related to both time and space. However, in international relations migration is considered on the basis of some parameters/criteria which may not be inclusive. Certain parameters have been set by international bodies to classify migration and types of migration. It is always difficult to conceptualize migration and give a substantive definition.

The International Organization of Migration (IOM) gives a definition for migration. It refers to the movement with respect to one's habitual residence. A person may have to leave habitual place of residence and move within a border of a State or across an international border. This definition emphasizes on the movement from the habitual place of residence irrespective of the legal status of the person and causes of the movement or even the duration of the person's stay in another place.

The definition of migration provided by the World Health Organization (WHO) is almost in the line of IOM definition with specifying categories of migrants as displaced people, refugees, economic migrants, and people moving for various purposes like family reunification. Further, WHO's definition identifies different categories of migrants as 'settlers', 'transit migrants' and 'circular migrants'. 'Settlers' may live in their home country or cross border in a host country. 'Transit migrants' are those who move on to another country using one country for transit purpose. 'Circular migrants' move into and leave countries periodically like seasonal workers.

Migration involving spatial movement, usually at international level, is considered while classifying migrants. As there can be voluntary migration and involuntary migration. There can be legal immigrants and illegal immigrants in a country. There can be refugees and asylum seekers crossing international boundaries and entering or